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Course: 21LEM202T - Universal Human Values - II

Unit – 4 : Session – 4 | Existence as Co-existence — Units Submerged in Space

Part C — Long-Answer Questions (Solutions)

1. Q1. EXISTENCE = CO-EXISTENCE = 'units submerged in space'. Whatever exists — every unit, from an atom to a galaxy, from a blade of grass to a human being — is IN SPACE: space is all-pervading, unlimited, transparent, and every unit is submerged in it, energised and being reflected in it. Nothing exists outside or without space. Hence existence is not a heap of separate things but ONE co-existence: units in mutual relationship within the all-pervading space.
2. Q2. UNITS are of two kinds: MATERIAL units (including pranic bodies) — they have ACTIVITY (composition/decomposition, respiration), are TEMPORARY in the sense of changing form, and are limited in size. CONSCIOUSNESS units (the Self, 'I') — their activity is knowing, assuming, recognising, fulfilling, desiring, thinking; they are continuous (the Self does not decompose like the body). The human being is co-existence of both: a consciousness unit associated with a material unit (body). SPACE itself: unlimited, all-pervading, no activity, no energy in the material sense — yet every unit is energised within it.
3. Q3. HARMONY IS INHERENT in existence: units are already submerged in space in mutual relation; the four orders are already in cyclical mutual fulfilment; nothing in nature is in isolation or chaos. The HUMAN ROLE: since harmony already exists, the human being has only to UNDERSTAND it (not create it) and LIVE accordingly — participate by right utilisation, protection and right feeling. Disharmony arises solely from the human's wrong assumption; right understanding restores participation in the pre-existing harmony. This is why the proposal is verifiable: harmony is the fact, not the ideal to be manufactured.
4. Q4. FOUR SELF-REFLECTION ANSWERS: (1) Am I submerged in space? Yes — inseparably, at every moment; I cannot step out of existence. (2) Am I related to the other units around me? Yes — air, water, plants, people continuously participate in my living, and I in theirs, whether I notice it or not. (3) Is my unhappiness caused by existence or by my assumptions? By my assumptions — existence is in harmony; my contradictions are in my unverified images. (4) What changes if I see existence as co-existence? My stance shifts from consumption to participation: right utilisation of things, protection of pranic and animal orders, relationship with humans — and the search for 'meaning' ends in understanding what already is.